Elections in the state of Bihar were scheduled at the end of the month where the BJP in alliance with the Janata Dal (United) was seeking to retain power facing opposition from the coalition of the Congress and the Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD). Way back in the month of June, Bihar's chief electoral officer H.R. Srinivasa had chaired an all-party meet to discuss safety measures which would need to be adopted leading up to the upcoming polls. While the BJP was prepared to take the virtual route for all its rallies, the opposition parties were very uncomfortable with the idea of cancelling in-person rallies citing that they didn't have the kind of resources the BJP did in order to ensure deep penetration of virtual meetings. This was after Union Home Minister Amit Shah had held a very penetrating virtual rally watched by at least 40 lakh people in which the party was believed to have pumped in tens of crores of rupees.[9] An RJD MLA had said, 'We do not have the resources and even workers to enable Tejashwi Yadav to address a large number of party workers. It is an uneven battle.'[10] The Congress meanwhile said that it was against completely banning traditional modes of campaigning. Congress leader B.P. Munan had said at the all-party meet, 'After all, how does one reach out to a population, which has no access to smartphones or the internet?'[11] Abandoning all virtual modes of campaigning, leading up to the elections, for several weeks all political parties held massive physical rallies attracting huge crowds with hardly anyone wearing masks or observing social distancing. While the flouting of COVID-19 rules alarmed the doctors of the sharp downturn in the fight against the virus it could take, Bihar miraculously managed to keep COVID-19 cases under control.[12]

Concurrently, in another large democracy like ours—the US—town halls, big rallies and conventions were being regularly held in the run-up to the national presidential elections scheduled in November 2020. Expectantly, they were being accompanied by huge spikes in COVID-19-positive cases in the destinations of the political rallies. By this time, about 50 countries in the world had gone ahead and held elections at various levels during the pandemic with varying levels of protocols and election management. While we saw a seven-day average in cases increase in some countries such as Singapore, Dominican Republic, Croatia, Serbia, Belarus